

Technology News

Now, turn your palm into a touchscreen

Have you ever thought of an 'imaginary phone' that lets you keep your cellphone in your pocket and answer calls by tapping your hand? Well, researchers at Potsdam University in Germany have developed just such a phone, which will enable you to simply slide a finger across your palm to answer phone calls remotely.

"Thanks to a wearable depth camera, you could interact with your palm the way you would use a touchscreen; all the touch inputs would be sent to the phone via Wi-Fi. The entire system has no physical or visual feedback, so it relies entirely on your muscle memory to remember what it's like to use your smartphone without, you know, actually using it," says a report.

"We envision that users will initially use imaginary phones as a shortcut to operate the physical phones in their pockets. As users get more experienced, it might even become possible to leave the device at home and spend the day 'all-imaginary,'" Dr Patrick Baudisch told New Scientist.

Currently, the phone uses a large depth camera mounted to an extending arm, but researchers are mulling over miniaturising it.

Now, a 'swimming' capsule endoscope

Japanese researchers have developed a self-propelled remote controlled capsule endoscope—Mermaid—that can move (or 'swim') from one part of the digestive tract to another.

Researchers claim that they have been successful in capturing images inside a person's stomach and colon using the tadpole-shaped capsule as a first step toward its clinical application.



Invisible phone answers calls with your hand

The device is about 1 cm (0.4 inches) in diameter and 4.5 cm (1.8 inches) long, and has a magnetic driving gear that allows to control its direction and location. Doctors need to use a joystick to control the capsule's movements, watching them on a monitor screen. It can be swallowed for examination of the stomach or inserted rectally for the colon.

"By remotely controlling the capsule, we can precisely photograph the area which needs to be tested," said Kazuhide Higuchi, professor, Osaka Medical College.

Device that possesses your hand

Want to play piano but find it too difficult? Thanks to a new device that can take control of your hand and teach you how to play a musical instrument.

PossessedHand, being developed by researchers at the University of Tokyo, Japan, and Sony Computer Science Laboratories in Tokyo, electrically stimulates the muscles in the forearm

that move your fingers. A belt worn around that part of the subject's arm contains 28 electrode pads, which flex the joints between the three bones of each finger and the two bones of the thumb, and provide two wrist movements.

"The user's fingers are controlled without the user's mind," said Emi Tamaki, researcher, University of Tokyo.

Devices that stimulate people's fingers have been made before, but they used electrodes embedded in the skin, which are invasive, or glove-like devices that make it hard to manipulate an object. Tamaki claims that PossessedHand is far more comfortable.

"The electric stimulations are similar to low-frequency massage stimulations that are commonly used," she said.

Click a pic with a hand-wave

Now you can take a self-portrait with the wave of your hand. Thanks to a digital camera developed